

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

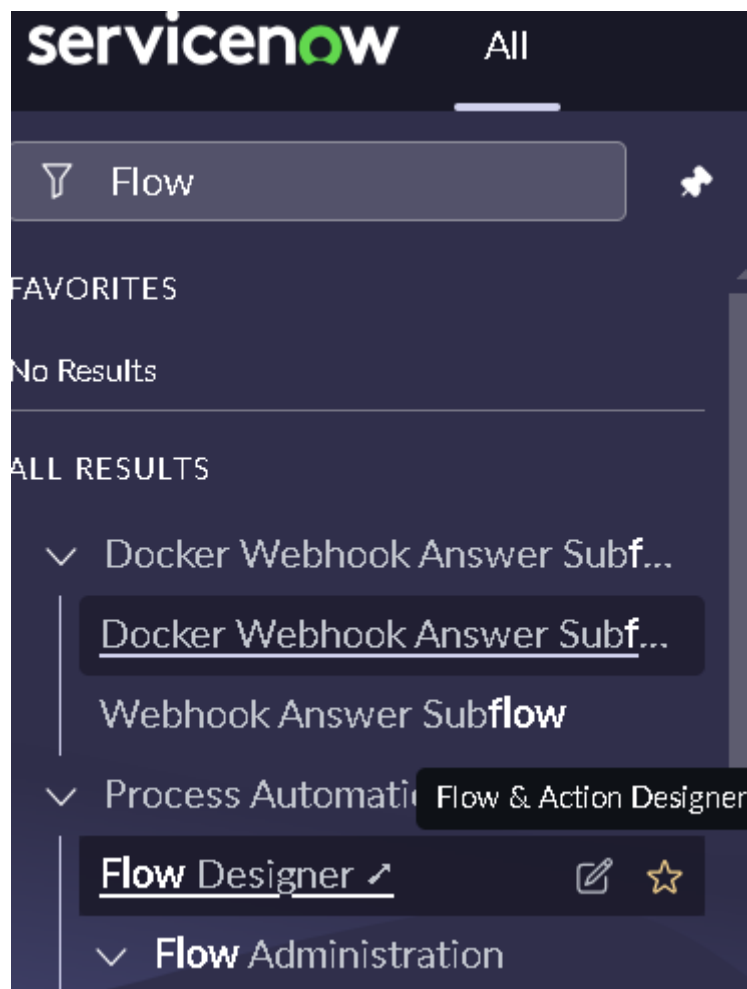
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.



servicenow Flow Designer

Flows Subflows Actions Executions Connections Help

New ▾

- Flow
- Subflow
- Action
- Data Stream

Search Updated ▾ Search

All

	Name	Internal name	Application	Status	Active	Updated ▾	Updated by
☐	Standard Laptop task	standard_laptop_task	Global	Published	true	2024-04-16 23:33:53	admin
☐	Email Sending For P1	email_sending_for_p1	Global	Published	false	2024-04-16 04:22:31	admin
☐	Daily Task Reminder	daily_task_reminder	Global	Draft	false	2024-04-16 00:06:03	admin

Flow properties

* Flow name

Description

Application

Protection

Run As

Cancel Submit

- Click on Add a trigger
- Select the trigger in that Search for “Service Catalog ” and select that.
- After that click on Done.


Flow VPN ×
Flow Email sending for P1 ×
Flow Standard laptop task ×
+


Standard laptop task Inactive
View:  

TRIGGER

✕ Abort trigger creation

Trigger

Select a Trigger

Search triggers

RECORD

Created

Updated

Created or Updated

DATE

Daily

Created

Trigger initiates from a ServiceNow record creation that meets the condition filter.

ACTIONS

+ Add an Action, Flow

ERROR HANDLER



TRIGGER


Service Catalog
 

Trigger

Service Catalog

Advanced Options

Delete Cancel Done

12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.

Standard Laptop task Active

✕ Action Flow Logic Subflow

Search Actions

Create Catalog Task

Most Recent

Popular

INSTALLED SPOKES

- ServiceNow Core
- Connect
- AES Portal UI Template
- Deployment Pipeline
- Virtual Agent
- Password Reset
- AES Flow Templates
- Global

Create Catalog Task
ServiceNow Core

Look Up Record
ServiceNow Core

Wait For Condition
ServiceNow Core

Create Record
ServiceNow Core

SLA Percentage Timer
ServiceNow Core

Send Email
ServiceNow Core

Update Record
ServiceNow Core

Create Template ACL

Standard Laptop task Active

View: [Icons] | Test De

1 Create Catalog Task ⓘ

Action: Create Catalog Task

Table Name: Catalog Task [sc_task]

* Requested Item [Requested Item]: Trigger - ... ▶ Requested Item ...

Short Description: Laptop needs to Configured

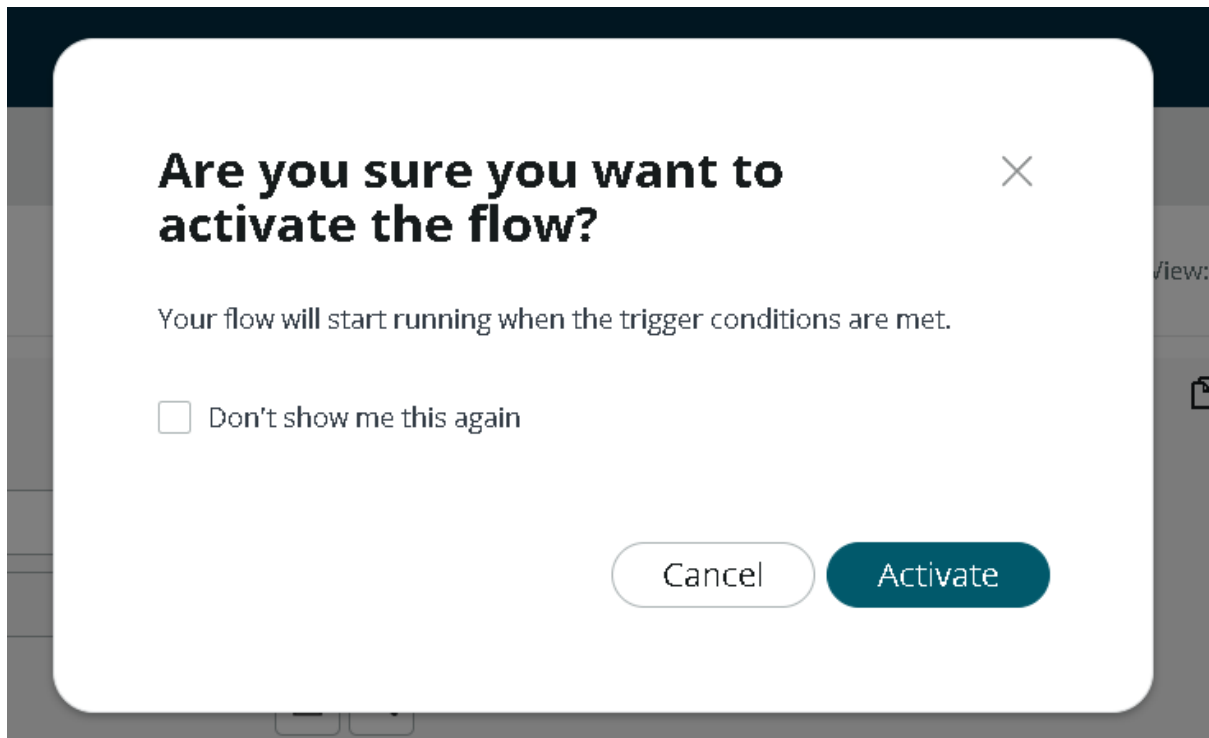
Fields:

Description	Laptop needs to Configured
Assignment group	Hardware
Approval	Approved

+ Add field value

Wait: ☒

Template Catalog: Select Template Catalog Item



Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

servicenow All

Favorites History Workspaces Admin

Catalog Items

Search

Actions on selected rows... New

All > Type != Bundle > Class != Order guide > Type != Package > Class != Content Item > Published item is empty > Name starts with standard

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
standard	Search	Search	Search	Search	Search	Search	!=Package	Search
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbonx1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27"; Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

FAVORITES

No Results

ALL RESULTS

- Service Catalog
 - Catalog Definitions
 - Maintain Catalogs
 - Maintain Categories
 - Maintain Dynamic Categories
 - Maintain Items
 - Maintain Cart Layouts
 - Service Catalog Wizards
 - Maintain Wizards

< Catalog Item Standard Laptop

Update Copy Try It Edit in Catalog Builder De

Name Standard Laptop Application Global ⓘ

Catalogs Service Catalog Active ☒

Category Hardware ⓘ

Fulfillment automation level Unspecified

State -- None --

Checked out -- None --

Owner ⓘ

Item Details Process Engine Picture Pricing Portal Settings

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow Standard Laptop task ⓘ

Workflow ⓘ

Execution Plan ⓘ

Update Copy Try It Edit in Catalog Builder Delete

Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.



[Favorites](#) [History](#) [Workspaces](#) [Admin](#) [Standard Laptop](#)

[Service Catalog](#) > [Hardware](#) > [Standard Laptop](#)

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

☐ Adobe Acrobat

☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Quantity

Subtotal ₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Delivery [Order Now](#) 0 Days

[Order Now](#)

[Add to Cart](#)

Shopping Cart

Empty

5. Now we will see the Order status

6. In that click on the Request Number

[Back to Catalog](#) [Continue Shopping](#) [Home](#)

Order Status

Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2024-04-17 04:07:11

Request Number: [REQ0010001](#)

Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2024-04-17

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo - Carbon x1	2024-04-17		₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually	1	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually
				Total	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

[Back to Catalog](#) [Continue Shopping](#) [Home](#)

7. It will open the Requested number record.

8. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

[Favorites](#) [History](#) [Workspaces](#) [Admin](#) [Request - REQ0010001](#)

[Request REQ0010001](#)

[Discuss](#) [Follow](#) [Update](#) [Add New Item](#) [Cancel Request](#) [Copy](#) [Delete](#)

Short description

Special instructions

[Update](#) [Add New Item](#) [Cancel Request](#) [Copy](#) [Delete](#)

Related Links
[Show Workflow](#)
[Workflow Context](#)

[Requested Items \(1\)](#) [Approvers \(1\)](#) [Recurring Prices \(1\)](#)

State

Actions on selected rows... [Edit](#)

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links
[Show Workflow](#)
[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1) Prices (1)

State

Approval for = REQ001

State

Approver

Comments

Created

2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

10. Then click on the Requested item Section

11. Open that Requested Item record

Favorites History Workspaces Admin

Requested Item - RITM0010001

Search

Discuss Follow Update Delete

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

Impact 3 - Low

Opened by System Administrator

Priority 4 - Low

State Open

Update Delete

Related Links
[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1) Approvers Group approvals

Number Search

Request item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

1 to 1 of 1

12. Scroll down to the “Catalog tasks ” Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.

